

FIRST TIME MEETING

How's it going?	How are you?	What's new?
How's your day going?	What are you up to today?	Any plans for the weekend/holiday?
What's your job?	How do you like it?	Do you live around here?
	What kind of games are you a fan of?	What do you do in your free time?
	Do you have any brothers or sisters?	What kind of food do you like?

- ❖ Break the ice and start a conversation with new clients.
- ❖ Building relationships with clients is important for business, and one way to start is by engaging in small talk.
- ❖ We'll be discussing some icebreaker questions, conversation starters, and compliments that you can use to make a good impression.

Icebreaker Questions:

1. How's your day going so far?
2. What brings you here today?
3. Have you visited this city before?
4. What do you enjoy doing in your free time?
5. Have you tried any of the local cuisine?
6. What kind of work do you do?
7. Are you familiar with our company?
8. Have you been to any interesting events recently?
9. What do you think of the weather?
10. Do you have any upcoming travel plans?

Conversation Starters:

1. That's a nice watch you're wearing, where did you get it?
2. Have you read any good books or watched any good movies lately?
3. I noticed you have a smartphone, do you have any favorite apps?
4. What do you think about the latest trends in the industry?
5. Do you have any hobbies or interests outside of work?
6. How did you get started in your line of work?

7. Are you a sports fan? Which team do you support?
8. I like your outfit, it looks very stylish.
9. Do you have any pets?
10. Do you have any recommendations for good restaurants in the area?

Compliments:

1. You have a great smile.
2. Your work is impressive.
3. That's a nice tie you're wearing.
4. Your hair looks great.
5. You have a great sense of humor.
6. Your English is very good.
7. Your presentation was fantastic.
8. That's a cool pen you have.
9. You have a nice accent.
10. You have a great sense of style.

Practice:

In pairs, take turns introducing yourselves, using one of the icebreaker questions to start a conversation, and giving a genuine compliment. Try to keep the conversation flowing by asking follow-up questions.

Conclusion:

By using these icebreaker questions, conversation starters, and compliments, you'll be able to break the ice and start building relationships with your clients. Remember to keep the conversation light and positive, and don't be afraid to show your personality.

VOTE ON THE MOST CREATIVE ICE BREAKER QUESTION – 3 PRO BUCKS AND PICK NEXT TOPIC.

1. Two Truths and a Lie: Have each student come up with two true statements about themselves and one false statement. The rest of the class has to guess which statement is the lie by asking ice breaker questions.
 2. Guess Who: Have each student write down three fun facts about themselves on a piece of paper. Collect the papers and read the fun facts out loud to the class. The class has to guess which student wrote each set of fun facts by asking ice breaker questions.
 3. Speed Networking: Set up a speed networking event where students have to introduce themselves to each other and ask an ice breaker question before moving on to the next person. Give each pair a set amount of time to talk before moving on to the next person. At the end, have students vote on the person they connected with the most.
 4. Would You Rather: Have students take turns asking "Would You Rather" questions as ice breakers. For example, "Would you rather have the power of flight or the power of invisibility?" After each question, have the class vote on which option they would choose and why.
 5. Picture Prompt: Give each student a random picture and have them come up with an ice breaker question or prompt based on the picture. Have students share their ice breaker questions with the class and vote on the most creative one.
 6. Memory Game: Create a memory game with ice breaker questions or prompts on each card. Students take turns flipping over two cards at a time and trying to match the ice breaker questions. If they match, they have to answer the question before taking another turn. The student with the most matches at the end wins a prize.
- improvise the rest of the conversation. After each role play, have the class vote on the most creative ice breaker question.

THE BASICS

Hello, I'm Sep. What's your name?

Hello Sep, I'm Charlie, ***nice to meet you.***

Nice to meet you too.

Ready with your ice breaker question/comment

- Simple question (western culture) **This step is important** - WHY?
 - Could start a conversation, which in the future could turn into a friendship, new client, or another contact in your network.
- ❖ Don't miss these opportunities to build relationships. Even if you never see them again, you practiced speaking English and gained confidence for next time.
- What to say next? - This depends on the situation – In general:
 - How are you? How's it going? How's your day going? What are you up to? (now)
 - Use the things around you for topics/ideas to bring up –
 - Have you been here before?
 - Restaurant – Do you like hot pot?
 - Coffee Shop – Are you a coffee drinker?
 - Mall – This place is huge...what are you shopping for today?

Your ideas:

GIVE A GENUINE COMPLIMENT

GIVE A COMPLIMENT. JUST MAKE SURE IT'S HONEST. EVERYONE LIKES A COMPLIMENT

- I like your shoes, are they new?
- You look very fashionable, maybe you could give me some tips.
- I love those earrings, where'd you get them?

Practice meeting and starting a conversation with someone in different scenarios.

- 1) New client in person and online
- 2) New colleague at a training session - Lower and Higher position than you
- 3) Someone introduces you
- 4) You introduce someone
- 5) You are introduced to the Hiring manager before an interview

WHERE ARE YOU MOST LIKELY TO MEET PEOPLE? ROLE PLAY THOSE REAL-LIFE SITUATIONS

- ❖ In pairs, take turns breaking the ice by giving real compliments: something simple and true, and don't forget to ABC with follow up questions.
- ❖ Use the examples and come up with your own that suite your personality and speaking style.

Your ideas:

1. I love your hairstyle, it suits you so well!
2. That's a beautiful dress you're wearing, where did you get it?
3. Your shoes are so stylish, they really complete your outfit.
4. Your earrings are stunning, they really catch the light.
5. You have a great smile, it's very warm and welcoming.
6. Your work on that project was impressive, you really went above and beyond.
7. I appreciate the effort you put into that presentation, it was very informative.
8. Your positive attitude is infectious, it's always a pleasure to work with you.
9. Your passion for your work really shines through, it's inspiring to see.
10. You have a great sense of humor, it's always a joy to talk to you.

Remember, the key to giving a good compliment is to be genuine and specific. Don't just say something generic like "you look nice", try to focus on something specific that you genuinely appreciate about the person.

1. That's a great haircut, it suits you really well.
2. Your work is really impressive, you're a talented designer.
3. You have a wonderful smile, it lights up the room.
4. That's a really interesting point you made, I never thought of it that way before.
5. Your presentation was really engaging, I learned a lot.
6. I love the way you've decorated your office, it's very stylish and welcoming.
7. You have such a positive energy, it's infectious.
8. Your sense of humor is fantastic, you always know how to make me laugh.
9. Your dedication to your work is really admirable, you always give 110%.
10. You have a great taste in music, I love the playlist you put together.
11. Compliment their outfit: I really like your [shirt, shoes, dress, etc.]. Where did you get it?
12. Ask about their favorite music: What kind of music do you like to listen to?
13. Talk about the weather: It's really hot/cold outside today. Have you been doing anything to stay cool/warm?
14. Ask about their travel experiences: Have you ever traveled anywhere interesting?
15. Ask about their favorite TV show or movie: Have you seen any good TV shows/movies lately?

PRO PRACTICE

- In pairs, take turns introducing yourselves and practicing icebreakers.
- Use the examples given and come up with your own.

MOST CREATIVE ICE BREAKER – PRO BUCKS AND PICK A GAME FOR TODAY

Meeting a new client:

You are meeting a new client and you are meeting them for the first time. Prompt: "Have you visited any interesting places in Vietnam since arriving here?"

Interviewing for a job:

You are interviewing for a job at a new company. Prompt: "What inspired you to pursue a career in IT?"

Meeting a colleague at a training session:

You are attending a training session and have just met a colleague from another company. Prompt: "What are your thoughts on the training so far?"

Meeting someone at a coffee shop:

You strike up a conversation with someone waiting in line at a coffee shop. Prompt: "Do you have any favorite coffee shops in the area?"

Meeting someone at a restaurant:

You are waiting for your food at a restaurant and start a conversation with the person at the table next to you. Prompt: "What do you recommend ordering here?"

Meeting someone at a park:

You are enjoying a relaxing afternoon at the park and meet someone walking their dog. Prompt: "What kind of dog do you have?"

Meeting someone at a gym:

You strike up a conversation with someone at the gym while taking a break from your workout. Prompt: "Do you have any favorite workout routines?"

Meeting someone at a social event:

You are attending a social event and meet someone new. Prompt: "What brings you to this event?"

Meeting someone at a bookstore:

You start a conversation with someone browsing in the same section as you at a bookstore. Prompt: "Do you have any favorite authors or genres?"

Meeting someone at a tech conference:

You are attending a tech conference and meet someone from a different company.

Prompt: "What was the most interesting talk you attended today?"

Here are some more advanced examples:

- If you could have dinner with any historical figure, who would it be and why?
- What's the most interesting place you've ever traveled to and why?
- If you could live in any time period, which one would you choose and why?

In groups of four, practice real-life scenarios such as:

- Networking at a conference, introducing yourself to a potential investor
- Meeting a new colleague at a company training session or holiday party
- Use the vocabulary words in your conversations.

Here are some more advanced phrases to use:

- "It's an honor to meet you (finally)."
- "I've heard great things about your work in the industry."
- "I'd like to present you to our team and give you a brief overview of our company."

THINK OF BETTER, MORE PERSONAL IDEAS

Meeting a new client: "What inspired you to get into your field?"

Meeting a new colleague: "What's your favorite thing about working in this industry?"

Meeting an interviewer: "What motivated you to apply for this position?"

Networking event: "What brought you to this event today?"

Coffee shop: "What's your favorite type of coffee?"

Party: "What's the most interesting thing you've done in the past year?"

Meeting someone at a gym: "What's your favorite workout routine?"

Bookstore: "What's the last book you read that you couldn't put down?"

Sports event: "Who's your favorite sports team?"

Museum: "What's your favorite type of art or exhibit to see?"

FOLLOW UP PHRASES

Copy the phrase and write another phrase that could follow

STRESS MEANING WORDS | PRACTICE TO YOURSELF WITH 5 CLASSMATES

1. “Hi, how are you?”

- a. Common greeting to start a conversation and show interest in the other person.

2. “Nice to meet you.”

- a. This is a polite way to introduce yourself and acknowledge the other person’s presence.

“Could you repeat that please?”

- b. Get in the habit of clearly asking this. Pretending to understand will likely cause issues down the road.

3. “I’m sorry, my English is not very good.”

- a. This is a humble way to acknowledge that English is not the developer’s first language and to ask for patience and understanding.

4. “Could you please repeat that?”

- a. If the co-worker or client uses technical language or jargon that the Vietnamese developer doesn’t understand, this is a polite way to ask them to explain it in simpler terms.

5. “Thanks a lot for the help, see you.” | Nice talking to you!”

- a. This is a friendly way to end a conversation and express enjoyment in the interaction.

6. “Do you have any advice for improving my English?”

- a. This is a proactive way for the Vietnamese developer to seek advice and improve their language skills.

Overall, using respectful language is always a **good call**. You can't go wrong. You will also influence the people around you to do the same.

- ❖ You will **gain their respect** when they notice you practicing your English with new people, not worrying about making mistakes, just being friendly, meeting and talking to new people.
- ❖ I cannot stress this aspect enough class. If you don't **go outside of your comfort zone** by speaking to the client, in the meeting, or your boss when you see him, or the foreigner at the store, you will never reach your goal.
- ❖ The good part is, the more you break the ice by starting a conversation with someone, the easier it becomes and soon you won't give your nerves a second thought when chatting with new people. Practice asking for clarification when needed, and expressing gratitude, as these are key elements of effective communication in social situations.

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER: HI, IT WAS NICE MEETING YOU TODAY. HOW WAS YOUR FLIGHT?

CLIENT: IT WAS GOOD, THANKS FOR ASKING. HOW ABOUT YOU? HOW WAS YOUR DAY?

Software Developer: It was busy, but productive. I'm excited to start working on the project.

Client: That's great to hear. I think we're going to make a great team.

Software Developer: Yes, I agree. By the way, if I don't understand something, do you mind explaining it to me in simpler terms?

Client: Of course not, feel free to ask me anything. And if you need any help, don't hesitate to reach out.

Software Developer: Thank you for your support. It was nice talking to you.

Client: Likewise. Have a good day!

Software Developer: Good morning, how are you doing today?

Manager: I'm doing well, thanks for asking. How about you?

Software Developer: I'm doing great, thanks. I'm really enjoying working on this project.

Manager: That's great to hear. I have some feedback for you. Are you free to discuss it later today?

Software Developer: Yes, that sounds good. I'm looking forward to hearing your feedback.

Manager: Great. By the way, if you're not sure about something, don't hesitate to ask me or anyone else on the team for help. We want to make sure we're on the same page every step of the way. You know what they say, teamwork makes the dream work.

Software Developer: Thank you, I appreciate your support. And if you need anything from me, just let me know.

Manager: Will do. So, what do you like to do outside of work?

Software Developer: I enjoy playing video games and spending time with my family. **How about you?**

Manager: I like to go hiking and exploring. Have you done any exploring around here?

Software Developer: Not yet, but I'm hoping to soon. Do you have any recommendations?

Manager: Definitely, there are some great trails nearby that I can recommend. We can discuss it later this week.

Software Developer: That sounds great, thank you. It was nice chatting with you, but I have to run to a meeting now. I'll see you later.

Manager: Likewise. Have a good day!

Speaking Activity 1: Storytelling Circle

In a group of 4-6 people, sit in a circle and take turns telling a story. The first person starts with a sentence or two, and then the next person picks up where they left off, continuing the story. Keep going around the circle until the story is complete. Try to use descriptive words and vivid imagery to make the story come alive. You can choose a theme or topic to guide the story, or just let it unfold organically.

Speaking Activity 2: Picture Description

In pairs, take turns describing a picture to your partner. Choose a picture with lots of details, such as a landscape or a busy street scene. The person describing the picture has to give as much detail as possible, while the other person listens and tries to visualize the scene. Then, switch roles and describe a different picture. This activity is ideal for practicing descriptive language and active listening.

Speaking Activity 2:

In a group of 4-6 people, choose a topic for debate. It can be a current event, a controversial issue, or a hypothetical scenario. Split the group in half, with one side arguing for the topic and the other side arguing against it. Each person gets a chance to make their argument, and then the other side gets a chance to rebut. The goal is to use persuasive language and logical arguments to convince the other side to see your point of view. This activity is great for practicing critical thinking and public speaking skills.